SHADOW SLAYER

Game Design Document (GDD)

Course: Game Development Fundamentals
Assignment: 8–9 — Mobile Game Kickoff

1. Game Title and Pitch

Shadow Slayer is a 2D action platformer where players control a swordsman, fight enemies, avoid dangerous obstacles, collect crystals, and defeat a powerful wizard boss.

The main goal is to complete all levels and defeat the final boss.

2. Genre and Platform

- **Genre:** 2D Action Platformer
- **Platform:** Mobile devices
- **Orientation:** Landscape
- **Game Engine:** Unity 6
- **Target Audience:** Players who enjoy platformers, action games, and boss battles

3. Game Type

Shadow Slayer is a **2D pixel-art game**.

The player moves through side-scrolling levels using a virtual joystick and on-screen buttons. The game uses 2D physics, animated sprites, enemy collision detection, and combat mechanics.

4. Core Gameplay Loop

The main gameplay loop consists of four actions:

Explore → Fight → Collect → Progress

1. **Explore:** Move through the level and jump between platforms.
2. **Fight:** Attack enemies using a sword.
3. **Collect:** Gather crystals and health pickups.
4. **Progress:** Reach the portal to unlock the next level.

Players repeat this loop until they reach the final boss.

5. Controls

The game uses touchscreen controls designed for mobile devices.

- **Virtual Joystick:** Moves the character left and right.
- **Jump Button:** Makes the character jump.
- **Attack Button:** Performs a sword attack.
- **Pause Button:** Stops gameplay and opens the pause menu.
- **Resume:** Continues gameplay.
- **Restart:** Restarts the current level.
- **Main Menu:** Returns to the main menu.

The HUD displays the player's health and collected crystals.

The interface uses Canvas Scaler, Anchors, and Safe Area to support different screen sizes.

6. Game Content

The game currently contains **three playable levels**.

Level 1 — Forest Beginning

- Basic movement and combat.
- Skeleton enemies.
- Crystals and health pickups.
- Spikes and moving platforms.
- Portal to the next level.

Level 2 — Forest Challenge

- More challenging platform sections.
- Skeleton enemies and additional obstacles.
- Moving platforms and collectible crystals.

Level 3 — Final Boss

- Boss battle against an Evil Wizard.
- The wizard attacks the player with magic projectiles.

- The player must avoid attacks and defeat the boss using a sword.
- Defeating the boss opens the victory screen.

7. Art Style and Sound

Visual Style: 2D pixel art with a fantasy forest environment.

The game uses animated characters, forest backgrounds, platforms, crystals, and magic effects. Assets from different sources are selected to maintain a consistent visual style.

Audio includes:

- Background music.
- Sword attack sound effects.
- Crystal collection effects.
- Enemy and boss combat sounds.
- Boss battle music.

The Settings menu allows players to adjust Music and SFX volume and mute the audio.

Third-party assets and their sources are documented in the project.

8. Minimum Viable Product (MVP)

The target for the Week 15 version is a complete, playable mobile game containing:

- Three playable levels.
- Working touchscreen controls.
- Enemies and boss combat.
- Health and crystal collection systems.
- Main Menu, Settings, HUD, and Pause Menu.
- Music and sound effects.
- Basic progress saving.
- A functional victory screen.
- A tested mobile-ready build.

The main priority is stable gameplay, responsive controls, and a clear user interface.

9. Cut List

To keep the project realistic and achievable, the following features are excluded from the MVP:

- Multiplayer and online gameplay.
- Character customization.
- Advanced inventory systems.
- Additional playable characters.

These features may be considered after the main game is completed.

10. Development Plan — Weeks 9–13

Week	Planned Development
Week 9	Finalize the GDD, GitHub repository, mobile HUD, Safe Area, and Pause Menu.
Week 10	Improve enemy AI, skeleton behavior, and boss attack patterns.
Week 11	Improve level content and implement basic progress saving.
Week 12	Improve sound effects, background music, and audio balance.
Week 13	Add visual effects, improve combat feedback, test gameplay, and fix bugs.

Weeks 14–15: Final testing, optimization, preparation for release, and project presentation.

Project Goal: Develop Shadow Slayer into a polished and enjoyable 2D mobile action platformer with responsive controls, challenging gameplay, and a consistent pixel-art style.